Railways has a railway station by the name of Pandit Ram Prasad Bismil, 11 km (6.8 miles) from Shahjahanpur. [123]

AZAD HIND FAUJ AND THE RAILWAYS

There is an interesting anecdote of how Subhash Chandra Bose and his Indian National Army used trains during their journeys and how the trains could only run during the night to avoid air attacks from British aircraft. The anecdote narrates how Bose would visit his troops during the halts. B.M.S. Bisht, former general manager, North-east Frontier Railway, wrote a piece in January 2010, first published on the website of the Indian Railway Traffic Service (IRTS) about the war-torn journeys.

The Azad Hind Fauj, or the Indian National Army (INA), used the railways as a means of transport for dispatching their troops in various campaigns in Burma. Major General Shah Nawaz Khan of the INA, who later became the deputy minister of Railways in independent India, writes in *My Memories of INA and Its Netaji* (1946):

> The advance parties of Regimental Headquarters and the two battalions viz. No. 2 and 3 moved to Rangoon by train to Mandalay on 4 and 5 February 1944 but on the way, owing to the railway bridges being blown by enemy aircraft, the men had to cover considerable distances on foot […] Later the INA troops left for Kalewa in Burma near the Indian border in parties of approximately 300 men and undertook the journey from Mandalay to Yeu in Burma by train and on foot. […] From Tamu to Humine and Ukhrul in Manipur and then to Kharsom and Kohima on arrival our men hoisted the tricolour on the lofty mountains around Kohima…

The former British intelligence officer Hugh Toye in his well-known classic *The Springing Tiger* (1959) prefaces the departure of the INA troops by rail with an exciting background:

> Bose arrived in Rangoon with the key members of his Headquarters and Cabinet on 17 January 1944 and he discussed with the Japanese Commander-in-Chief General Kwabe the coming invasion of India. He saw his national flag planted at Imphal, Kohima, even on the banks of the Brahamputra and the people of India welcoming him with open arms. […] On 24 January he spent the whole day with the regiment, reviewing, watching it at exercises and parade, talking to his officers.
>
> On 3 February he bade farewell arousing them by his inspiring call: ‘Blood is calling. Arise! We have no time to lose. Take up your arms […] The road to Delhi is the road to freedom (Delhi chalo!).’
>
> The regiment left for the front during the next three days and Netaji watched their trains move and he could not withhold his tears…